OPPORTUNITY BRIEF · SALES AND PRESALES

# Deploy drone detection and intervention systems at airports to counter unauthorized drone incursions.

Transportation and Logistics × Drone detection and airspace protection × Drones and UAS · OS020 v1 · refreshed 2026-08-18

| ATTRACTIVENESS | RIGHT TO WIN | COMPETITION | SERVICEABLE MARKET | HORIZON | PORTFOLIO |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **82**<br>is the world moving | **49**<br>can we play, can we win | **MEDIUM**<br>0 named in the evidence | **€61.9m**<br>partial evidence · per year | **NEXT**<br>regulation adopted or propose... | **L0**<br>19 signals |

Attractiveness and right to win are scored and displayed separately and are never combined (SC-12). Competition is a fourth quantity, not a discount on either.

## The opportunity

Airports worldwide are facing a growing threat from unauthorized drone incursions, which have caused operational disruptions and security scares. Orange Business can deploy its Orange Drone Guardian solution, combining detection and intervention capabilities, to protect airport airspace and ensure safety. This opportunity is urgent now because regulators and aviation authorities are pushing for mandatory counter-drone measures, and airports are actively seeking proven solutions.

## Market opportunity

| Method | Total (TAM) | Serviceable (SAM) | Obtainable (SOM) | Confidence |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Bottom-up: enterprises x adoption x contract value | **€99.3m**<br>€21.7m – €579m | **€61.9m**<br>€13.5m – €361m | **€928k**<br>€203k – €5.4m | partial |
| Observed: tendered contract value, annualised | €115m | €115m | €1.7m | observed |

All figures are annual, in EUR. Ranges compound the uncertainty of each factor below; the base case is the middle column of each.

### Bottom-up: enterprises x adoption x contract value

| Factor | Value | Basis | Source | As of |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Enterprises in Transportation and Logistics (EU27_2020) | 113,199 enterprises | observed | Eurostat · sbs_sc_ovw | 2024 |
| Enterprises adopting Drones and UAS | 0.8 % of enterprises (10+ employees) | proxy | Eurostat · isoc_eb_ain2 · E_AI_TAR | 2025 |
| Annual value of one engagement | €792k per enterprise per year | observed | TED (Tenders Electronic Daily) · ted | 2026-05-26..2026-08-05 |
| Size-weighted buyer base | 14,748 enterprise-equivalents at large-enterprise engagement value | assumption | config/sizing.yaml · size_class_value_weights | size-2026-08-a |
| Assumed obtainable share of the serviceable market | 1.5 % of SAM | assumption | config/sizing.yaml · obtainable_share | size-2026-08-a |

**Read this before quoting the number.** Adoption rate is a declared proxy. Artificial intelligence by NACE Rev. 2 activity series E_AI_TAR is used as a proxy for Drones and UAS: Autonomous machines — includes autonomous drones. Contract values are observed from EU public procurement (TED). For private-sector verticals they are used as a proxy for comparable enterprise deal size: the buying entity differs, the scope of work is comparable. Engagement value is scaled by enterprise size class (10-19: x0.04, 20-49: x0.09, 50-249: x0.35, GE250: x1.0), because the observed contract value comes from large-organisation tenders. 3 of 6 declared geographies are outside the European reference data (VN, US, IL); the estimate covers the European footprint only.

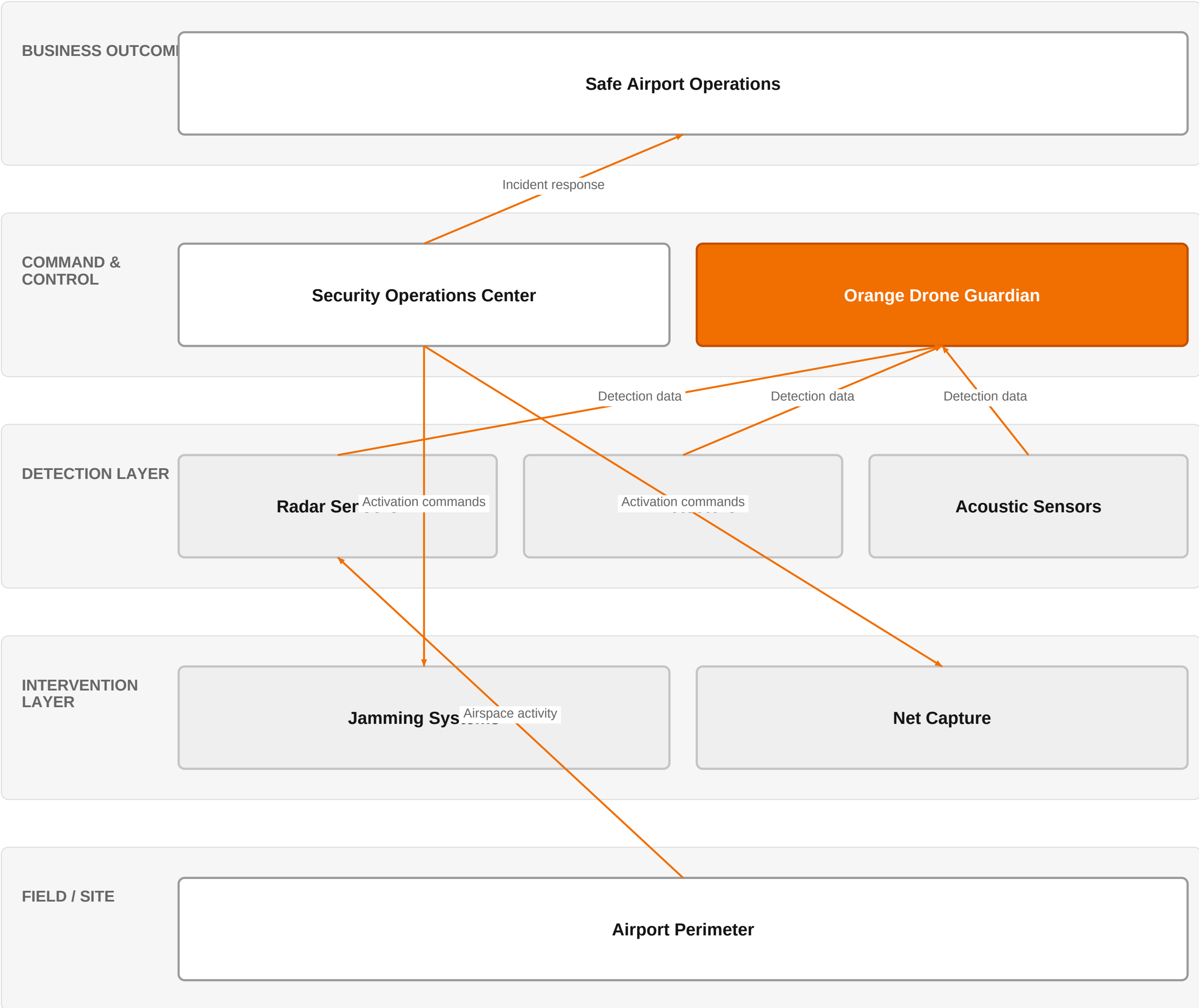
### Observed: tendered contract value, annualised

| Factor | Value | Basis | Source | As of |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Tendered contract value in matching CPV categories | €115m per year | observed | TED (Tenders Electronic Daily) · ted | 2026-05-26..2026-08-05 |
| Assumed obtainable share of the serviceable market | 1.5 % of SAM | assumption | config/sizing.yaml · obtainable_share | size-2026-08-a |

**Read this before quoting the number.** Observed over 85 days of TED coverage and scaled to a year (x4.3); a short collection window makes that scaling rough. 8 matching notices, matched on vertical via the CPV crosswalk — §4.5.2's warning applies: a crosswalk error lands directly in this number. Public procurement only. Private-sector demand for the same capability is not visible here at all, so this is a floor rather than a market size. 3 of 6 declared geographies are outside the European reference data (VN, US, IL); the estimate covers the European footprint only.

## The solution, in one picture

### Airport Drone Defense Architecture




■ Orange asset ■ Partner ■ Customer-owned ■ Third party / to be sourced

This diagram shows how Orange Drone Guardian integrates detection sensors and intervention tools into the airport's security operations to protect airspace.

Boxes marked as Orange assets are validated against the linked business graph; a box the model claimed for Orange without a matching asset is shown as third party.

## What has changed

Unauthorized drone incursions at airports are increasing, with incidents at Ben Gurion, Leipzig, and Tan Son Nhat airports causing shutdowns and flight disruptions. Vietnam has admitted its airports lack drone-detection gear and is proposing investment in detection and neutralization systems. Germany is expanding drone security research after an explosive drone was found at an airport, and Prague Airport has launched a security review following a drone scare. Europe is urged to do more to protect airports from Russian drones. These events highlight a regulatory and operational shift toward mandatory counter-drone capabilities.

`Sources: SIG-CBC989FFDC45 JFeed 2026-08-11; SIG-A2F1227AE5E4 UA.NEWS 2026-08-08; SIG-A776E54DD2E6 Tech Times 2026-08-12; SIG-7214FADD192F Vietnam.vn 2026-08-12; SIG-7E90A97DA15B Tekedia 2026-08-09; SIG-F33C1CE85035 Expats.cz 2026-08-07`

## Who buys, and why now

The airport operations director or head of security signs the contract, but the pain is felt by air traffic controllers and security teams who must manually spot drones and coordinate responses. The trigger is a specific drone incident—like the Tan Son Nhat shutdown or the Leipzig scare—that forces a review and accelerates budget approval. They need to prevent flight disruptions, ensure passenger safety, and comply with emerging regulations.

## Why it is hot now — every claim bound to a dated source

- Airports worldwide report unauthorized drone incursions, with notable incidents at Ben Gurion and Leipzig airports. [SIG-CBC989FFDC45, SIG-A2F1227AE5E4]
- Vietnam admits airports lack drone-detection gear after Tan Son Nhat shutdown, and proposes investment in detection and neutralization systems. [SIG-A776E54DD2E6, SIG-7214FADD192F]
- Germany expands drone security research after an explosive drone was found at an airport, and Prague Airport reviews security after a drone scare. [SIG-7E90A97DA15B, SIG-F33C1CE85035]
- Europe is urged to do more to protect airports from Russian drones. [SIG-A3FF6AA13487]

## What Orange would deliver, and why it can win

### What Orange would deliver

Orange would deliver the Orange Drone Guardian solution, leveraging its cybersecurity and defense experts to integrate detection sensors, command-and-control software, and intervention capabilities. The engagement would start with a site assessment and threat analysis, then deploy a layered detection system (radar, RF, acoustic) tailored to the airport's layout, followed by integration with existing security operations and training for staff. Orange Group researchers would support continuous improvement and adaptation to evolving threats.

### Why Orange can win

Orange can win because it combines telecom-grade network reliability with cybersecurity and defense expertise, offering a fully managed service that reduces the airport's operational burden. The Orange Drone Guardian is a proven offer, and the reference Point One Navigation demonstrates successful deployment. Unlike pure security vendors, Orange can integrate drone detection with broader connectivity and IT services, providing a single point of accountability.

### Named assets behind this — each individually inspectable (LK-08)

| Asset | Type | Link | Why it is linked | Curator |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Orange Drone Guardian | offer | L0 | offer addresses the use case AND provides the technology | unconfirmed |
| Cybersecurity experts | capability pool | SUP | capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology | unconfirmed |
| Defense and security experts | capability pool | SUP | capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology | unconfirmed |
| Orange Group researchers | capability pool | SUP | capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology | unconfirmed |
| Point One Navigation | reference | SUP | published reference in this vertical, different use case | unconfirmed |

## Competitive landscape

**MEDIUM** competitive intensity (score 5.6; 0 of 8 listed players appear in this topic's own evidence)

A real field, including at least one player the customer will already know. Expect to be compared.

| Competitor | Category | Position here | Basis | Evidence |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Airbus Protect | Security specialist | sells Drones and UAS; competes in Cybersecurity | structural | — |
| Dedrone by Axon | Security specialist | sells Drones and UAS; active in Transportation and Logistics; competes in Cybersecurity | structural | — |
| HENSOLDT | Security specialist | sells Drones and UAS; competes in Cybersecurity | structural | — |
| Leonardo | Security specialist | sells Drones and UAS; competes in Cybersecurity | structural | — |
| Thales | Security specialist | sells Drones and UAS; competes in Cybersecurity | structural | — |
| Vodafone Business | Telecom operator peer | active in Transportation and Logistics | structural | — |
| Honeywell | Industrial / OT specialist | active in Transportation and Logistics | structural | — |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Boldyn Networks | Network equipment vendor | active in Transportation and Logistics | structural | — |

**evidenced** means this topic's own sources name the competitor — the signal ids are in the last column and are dated and clickable in the radar. **structural** means the curated register says they sell this technology into this vertical, which is true but is not proof they are in this deal. Register version competitors-2026-08-a.

## Qualifying questions for the first meeting

1. Have you experienced any unauthorized drone incidents at your airport in the past 12 months, and what was the operational impact?
2. What is your current process for detecting and responding to drone incursions, and who is responsible for it?
3. Are you aware of any upcoming regulations or mandates from your civil aviation authority regarding counter-drone systems?
4. Do you have a budget allocated for drone detection and intervention, and what is the expected timeline for deployment?
5. How do you currently manage security operations, and would you prefer an integrated solution or a standalone drone detection system?
6. What is your biggest concern when considering a counter-drone solution: cost, reliability, or regulatory compliance?

## Objections you will meet

| They will say | You can answer |
|---|---|
| We already have a security system in place; why do we need another layer? | That's a fair point. However, your existing system likely wasn't designed to detect small, low-flying drones. Orange Drone Guardian adds a specialized layer that integrates with your current security operations, enhancing your capability without replacing what you have. |
| Counter-drone technology is expensive and unproven. | Cost is a valid concern, but the cost of a single drone-induced shutdown can be far higher. Orange Drone Guardian is a proven solution, and as a managed service, it reduces upfront investment. We can also phase the deployment to align with your budget. |
| We are concerned about privacy and legal issues with drone intervention. | Privacy and legal compliance are critical. Our solution is designed to comply with local regulations, and we work with your legal team to ensure all interventions are lawful. We focus on detection and non-destructive mitigation where possible. |

## Risks and unknowns

The main risk is regulatory uncertainty: counter-drone regulations are still evolving, and airports may delay investment until mandates are clear. There is also a risk that the solution's effectiveness against sophisticated drone threats is unproven, as detection technologies have limitations in certain conditions. Additionally, the competitive landscape is crowded, and some competitors have established relationships with airports. What is not yet known is the specific performance of Orange Drone Guardian in diverse airport environments and the willingness of airports to adopt a managed service model.

## Next action, by role (FR-17)

| Role | Do this next |
|---|---|
| Presales / Proposal | Prepare a bid brief for a European airport operator that differentiates Orange Drone Guardian by leveraging Orange Group researchers and Point One Navigation as a reference, focusing on the integration of cybersecurity and defense expertise. |
| Sales | In a conversation with a European airport operator's head of security, say: 'Given the recent drone incidents at airports like Ben Gurion and Leipzig, and the regulatory push, we have an Orange Drone Guardian offer that integrates our cybersecurity and defense expertise to help you protect your airspace.' |
| Strategist / Innovator | Deep-dive on the regulatory timeline for drone detection mandates at airports, and prototype a threat-intel feed that combines Orange's cybersecurity and defense expertise with the Orange Drone Guardian offer. |

## Evidence

Every claim in this brief resolves to one of these. Tier 1 is an authoritative primary source; tier 4 is vendor-published material, discounted in scoring (§4.3.7).

| Signal | Date | Publisher | T | Title and link |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| SIG-DD814ADD17F5 | 2025-01-01 | cordis.europa.eu | 1 | Enabling Autonomous Aerial Systems through Operational Methods and Technological Enhancements |
| SIG-974818D83206 | 2026-08-16 | bing.com | 2 | Forget cameras, this new drone detection system just listens for the enemy instead |
| SIG-A3FF6AA13487 | 2026-08-16 | vijesti.me | 2 | Europe must do more to protect airports from Russian drones - vijesti.me |
| SIG-A13AF8F22F6B | 2026-08-15 | Vietnam.vn | 2 | Les drones menacent les aeroports : quelles sont les lacunes en matiere de gestion des operateu... |
| SIG-22C234101FAF | 2026-08-14 | Vietnam.vn | 2 | Mettre en place des groupes de travail charges de detecter les drones et d'intervenir dans les ... |
| SIG-7214FADD192F | 2026-08-12 | Vietnam.vn | 2 | L'Autorite de l'aviation civile propose d'investir dans un systeme de detection et de neutralis... |
| SIG-9FAA82ADDA6A | 2026-08-12 | Laodong.vn | 2 | La detection des drones penetrant dans les aeroports depend encore fortement de l'observation m... |
| SIG-A776E54DD2E6 | 2026-08-12 | Tech Times | 2 | Vietnam Admits Airports Have No Drone-Detection Gear After Tan Son Nhat Shutdown Hits Flights -... |
| SIG-CBC989FFDC45 | 2026-08-11 | JFeed | 2 | Unauthorized Drone Enters Ben Gurion Airport Airspace - JFeed |
| SIG-7E90A97DA15B | 2026-08-09 | Tekedia | 2 | Germany Expands Drone Security Research After Explosive Drone Found at Airport - Tekedia |
| SIG-A2F1227AE5E4 | 2026-08-08 | UA.NEWS | 2 | An air defense system was deployed at Leipzig Airport after a drone was detected - UA.NEWS |
| SIG-F33C1CE85035 | 2026-08-07 | Expats.cz | 2 | Drone scare in Germany prompts Prague Airport security review - Expats.cz |
| SIG-384A2D8D4310 | 2026-08-04 | bing.com | 2 | Airports are not ready for the drone era, new global study warns |
| SIG-4812FDBC16E3 | 2026-07-13 | airportindustry-news.com | 2 | How Airports Can Plan Drone Detection for Low-Altitude Airspace Operations - airportindustry-ne... |
| SIG-BCBC462A63E3 | 2026-07-09 | Police Magazine | 2 | New DroneShield Report Reveals Serious Gaps in Airport, Critical Infrastructure Counter-Drone S... |
| SIG-9FCAF3E022B5 | 2026-06-30 | ASIS International | 2 | Drone Reports Near U.S. Airports Reflect Rising Issue for Critical Infrastructure - ASIS Intern... |
| SIG-2F0861536F6A | 2026-06-23 | Bao VietNamNet | 2 | Drone detection system trialed at Da Nang International Airport - Bao VietNamNet |
| SIG-2CC796AF2DBE | 2026-06-01 | Unmanned airspace | 2 | Lithuania deploys drone detection system at Palanga Airport, Kaunas and Vilnius to follow - Unm... |
| SIG-50BA4C222C4C | 2026-06-01 | International Airport Rev... | 2 | Palanga Airport deploys advanced drone detection system to strengthen airspace security measure... |

## How this brief was made

**Computed, not written.** Attractiveness, right to win, competitive intensity and every figure in the market-opportunity section are computed from stored inputs and can be re-derived (DR-05, NFR-01). No language model produced a number anywhere in this document (§4.4.4).

**Written, then checked.** The narrative sections and the solution diagram were generated from this topic's evidence and from the named asset and competitor lists. Factual sections must cite signal ids attached to this topic; sections that failed that check, or that contained a generated quantity or an unsupplied organisation, were removed rather than rewritten.

Removed by those checks in this brief: competitive_landscape (no claim survived evidence binding)

| What | Version | When |
|---|---|---|
| Scores — weight set | w-2026-08-a | 2026-08-18T19:08:26+00:00 |
| Market sizing — assumptions | size-2026-08-a | 2026-08-18T21:06:13+00:00 |
| Competitor register | competitors-2026-08-a | 2026-08-18T21:06:16+00:00 |
| Narrative — prompt / model | describe-v1 / deepseek-chat | 2026-08-18T20:41:31+00:00 |
| Pipeline | 0.1.0 | 2026-08-18 |

Generated 2026-08-19 04:58 UTC. Scores computed under a different weight set are not comparable with these (SC-10), and neither are market sizes computed under a different sizing version.